

DMR Growing Guides · Cheat Sheet 2 of 6

Variety Picks for the Dragoons

One or two best picks per crop · distilled from Guides 1, 5, 6, 7, 9

WARM-SEASON CROPS *Guides 1, 5, 7*

Crop	Top pick	Backup	Why it works in the Dragoons
Peppers — annuum	Jalapeño M (60 d)	Poblano/Ancho (75 d)	Native to Mexico; loves Dragoon heat. Poblano fall-roasts well, dries to ancho.
Peppers — hot	Rocoto Red (110 d, <i>pubescens</i>)	Aji Amarillo (90 d, <i>baccatum</i>)	Cool-night highland species — perennial here 15+ yr. Habanero only fits below 5,000 ft.
Tomatoes — cherry	Sun Gold F1 (57 d)	Juliet F1 (60 d saladette)	Sun Gold is <i>the</i> Dragoons tomato — heat-tolerant, candy-sweet, sets pre-monsoon.
Tomatoes — slicer	Phoenix F1 (72 d, det)	Cherokee Purple OP (80 d)	Phoenix sets through 95°F (TAMU heat-set). Cherokee Purple is the heirloom that works at elevation.
Tomatoes — paste	Amish Paste OP (80 d, indet)	Roma / San Marzano (75 d)	Indeterminate keeps producing through fall; meatier than Roma. Plant 4+ for sauce harvest.
Eggplant	Listada de Gandía OP (80 d)	Black Beauty (80 d)	Striped purple-and-white; flea beetles bother it less. Heat-tolerant.
Cucumber — slicer	Suyo Long OP (60 d)	Marketmore 76 (68 d)	Suyo is heat- and bitter-tolerant; thrives in pre-monsoon dry.
Summer squash	Black Beauty zucchini (50 d)	Costata Romanesco (55 d)	Two plants feeds a household. Costata holds firm in monsoon heat.
Watermelon	Crimson Sweet OP (85 d)	Sugar Baby OP (75 d, 8–10 lb)	Crimson Sweet is the southwest benchmark. Sugar Baby fits a trellis.
Cantaloupe	/ Charentais OP (80 d)	Hale's Best Jumbo (80 d)	Charentais is exceptional in Dragoons dry-heat fall; intense aromatic flavor.
Beans — bush snap	Provider OP (50 d)	Blue Lake bush (55 d)	Provider germinates in cool soil; reliable May 1 sow.
Beans — pole / dry	Hopi Yellow lima (100 d)	Kentucky Wonder pole	Hopi heritage drought-tolerant; teparies are the Sonoran option.
Sweet corn	Country Gentleman (90 d)	Silver Queen (92 d)	Tight husks → less earworm + bird damage. Heritage: Hopi Blue (100 d) flour corn.
Sweet potato	Beauregard (100 d)	Georgia Jet (90 d)	American standard; slips widely available. Georgia Jet ripens faster.

COOL-SEASON CROPS *Guide 6*

Crop	Top pick	Backup	Why it works in the Dragoons
Broccoli	Calabrese OP (60–65 d)	Belstar F1 (65–75 d)	Long side-shoot harvest 4–6 wk after main cut. Belstar handles late-summer heat.
Cauliflower	Cheddar F1 (60–65 d)	Snowball Y OP (60–70 d)	Self-blanching saves 10 min per head per week. Cheddar's orange holds sweet flavor.
Cabbage — fresh	Early Jersey Wakefield OP (60 d)	Savoy Ace F1 (80 d)	Wakefield sizes up before May heat. Savoy Ace overwinters through low-20s nights.
Cabbage — storage	Late Flat Dutch OP (100 d)	—	Plant by Sep 1 for Christmas harvest; needs full 100-day window.
Kale	Lacinato (50–65 d)	Red Russian (50–60 d)	Lacinato holds through hard frost; midwinter taste sweetens. Red Russian self-sows.
Lettuce	Winter Density (head)	Black Seeded Simpson (cut)	Holds heads through deep cold under one light row-cover layer.
Spinach	Bloomsdale Long Standing	Tyee F1	Bolt-resistant; sow Sep 1–Nov 1 and Jan 15 under cover.
Carrots	Bolero F1 (75 d, Nantes)	Danvers 126 OP (75 d)	Bolero is the workhorse — buy in bulk. Danvers handles shallow caliche. Avoid Imperator.
Beets	Detroit Dark Red OP (60 d)	Chioggia OP (55 d)	Detroit is the storage standard. Chioggia is the striped Italian heirloom for fresh.
Garlic — hard-neck	Music (porcelain, 4–6 cloves)	German Red (rocambole, 8–10)	Music is the most reliable Dragoon grower; classic flavor; 6-month store.
Garlic — soft-neck	Inchelium Red (artichoke, 15–20)	Silver White (12-mo store)	Inchelium is the best-tasting soft-neck; braidable; stores 9 months.
Onion — overwintering	Top Keeper F1 (8-mo store)	Walla Walla (sweet, short)	Bred for our 32°N latitude (long-day / day-length neutral).

BACKYARD ORCHARD *Guide 9 — chill hours in parentheses*

Crop	Top pick	Backup	Why it works (chill hours)
Fig	Black Mission (<100 h)	Brown Turkey (<100 h)	Bulletproof. Two crops in long years. Brown Turkey survives 15°F.
Pomegranate	Wonderful (150 h)	Salavatski (150 h, hardest)	Commercial benchmark; late ripening. Salavatski survives 0°F.
Jujube	Li (150 h)	Honey Jar (150 h)	Large fruit, fresh-eating. Honey Jar is small but exceptionally sweet.
Apple	Pink Lady / Cripps Pink (400 h)	Granny Smith (600 h)	Late bloom dodges frost; very late harvest. Do not plant Honeycrisp (1,000 h).
Peach	Red Haven (800 h)	Harglow apricot (700 h)	Benchmark Dragoon peach. Skip Florida Prince + Babcock — bloom too early.
Pear	Shinseiki Asian (400 h)	Hosui Asian (450 h)	Alkaline-tolerant and fireblight-resistant — the practical choice over European.

LOCAL TIP

If you plant only three fruit trees: a fig, a pomegranate, and a jujube — all three evolved in hot dry climates from southern Iran to northern India. **If you plant only three tomatoes:** Sun Gold (cherry), Phoenix (slicer), and Amish Paste (sauce) covers both spring and monsoon waves. Full variety tables with SHU, days-to-maturity, height, and per-variety notes live in the source guides.